



Comments received by Verra during the public comment period 12 November 2024 to 12 December 2024 for the validation of the Agroflorestal Novo Horizonte Redd Aud Project, India- II- Project 5295

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Comment 1

Date: 12 December 2024

Sent by:

Organization:

Country:

The following aspects contained within the Project Description were seen as concerns:

Section 2.1.2 of the joint PD&MR states that the public consultation was held on 01/10/2021, before the project start date. An invitation and an informative folder about the project were distributed to the Vila Nova, Santa Teresinha, and Bom Jesus communities. Meetings were held with other stakeholders: employees, NGOs, public agencies, and conservation unit managers. It is not clear whether the Ramal do Meio community, described in Section 2.1.1 of the joint PD&MR, was invited or participated in the stakeholder consultation.

It is unclear whether the project proponent followed all instructions in the VM0015 v1.2 methodology to define the project boundaries (RR, PA LK, LMA and Forest) in Section 3.3 of the joint PD&MR. For example, it is unclear how large the RR was and whether this size met the proportion related to the PA, as defined in the methodology; the joint PD&MR does not demonstrate the similarity of deforestation risk in the RR and PA using the criteria agents and drivers of deforestation, landscape configuration and ecological conditions, as required by Section 5.1.1 of the methodology; it is not described whether LK was delineated using opportunity cost analysis or mobility analysis, as required by Section 5.1.3 of the methodology; it is not demonstrated whether LMA are non-forest areas, as required by Section 5.1.4 of the methodology; the forest boundary is not described in the joint PD&MR, as required by Section 5.1.5 of the methodology. Also, on page 99 of the PD, there is an inconsistency in the value of the LB area presented in the text and in the table.

It is unclear why Section 3.4 of the joint PD&MR was performed using VMD0007, not the steps indicated in the VM0015 methodology. According to the VMD0007 web page (<https://verra.org/methodologies/vmd0007-estimation-of-baseline-carbon-stock-changes-and-greenhouse-gas-emissions-from-unplanned-deforestation-bl-up-v3-3/>), "This module was assessed and approved as part of VM0007."

Table 33 of Section 3.4 of the joint PD&MR follows the VM0015 methodology related to the similarity of PD and RR in ecological conditions, especially elevation and slope. The socio-economic and cultural conditions of similarity are not adequately described in the joint PD&MR.

Section 3.4 of the joint PD&MR does not adequately describe the process of identifying deforestation agents and drivers and the underlying causes of deforestation, as required by Sections 6.2.1, 6.2.2, and 6.2.3 of the joint PD&MR.



Finally, the project did not conclude, as Section 6.2.5 of VM0015 required, whether the evidence available about the most likely future deforestation trend in the reference region and project area is inconclusive or conclusive.

3.5.2 Additionality Methods: it is not clear how scenario I is feasible if ""Agroflorestal Novo Horizonte's sustainable management areas are set to conclude in 2026, after which they will enter a period of fallow until 2050"". It is possible to conclude from the description of the joint PD&MR that scenario I will occur until 2026 and after this year, the area will enter a period of fallow due to legal compliance for sustainable forest management activity. From 2027 onwards, this scenario will no longer be an alternative during most of the project's crediting period, which goes until 09/10/2061. In other words, according to the project description, scenario I is not a feasible and possible scenario that would have occurred on the land within the proposed project boundary in the absence of the project activity in the next years of the project's duration.

According to the analysis described above, since all other steps of the VT0001 tool derive from the first step, it is not clear how additionality is demonstrated for the project. Also, it is advisable to clearly present the final result of each step in the additionality analysis.

It is not clear in Section 5.1 of the joint PD&MR how the steps of the entire section 8.1 of VM0015 methodology were met. The order of the analyses required by the methodology is not clear for the reader to check and replicate the document, and the equations used in each step of the joint PD&MR are not described.

The ""selection of the Baseline Approach"" (page 46 of the VM0015) is the last step of Section 8.1.3.1 - ""Projection of the Quantity of Future Deforestation"" of the VM0015. However, the project determines the baseline approach at the beginning of Section 5.1 of the joint PD&MR (""historical average method""). Therefore, it is difficult to understand the construction and logic, following the guidelines of the methodology, of how the project defined the baseline approach.

The project calculated the carbon stocks based on the forest inventory. However, it is not clear in the joint PD&MR whether the methods to estimate carbon stocks met the requirements of the methodology.

Section 5.3 of the joint PD&MR does not adequately describe the ex ante estimation of activities that will cause deforestation displaced outside the project boundary due to the implementation of the AUD project activity (Section 8.3.1.2 of the methodology). The order of the analyzes required by the methodology is not clear for the reader to check and replicate the document, and the equations used in each step of the joint PD&MR are not described.

Section 5.4 of the joint PD&MR includes tables with the quantification of estimated GHG emission reductions and carbon removals. However, the project did not describe the relevant equations and the quantifications estimated for the project crediting period, as required by the Template.

Section 5.4 of the joint PD&MR: The Rft value is described on page 184, but the way of calculating the 12% is not described in the PD. Also, it is needed to check if the updated NPR tool has been correctly used.

It is not clear why some Tables from Section 7.2 of the joint PD&MR present negative values. It is not clear whether all the ex-post equations, tables, and steps from the VM0015 methodology were followed in the joint PD&MR.

Section 6.1. Please justify why the Carbon Fraction of 0.48 was used instead of the more usual 0.47
